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Robert Preben Praas

Robert's research has appeared in Nature's Scientific Data and at the Socially Responsible Language Modelling Research workshop at NeurIPS. He speaks regularly on building AI in Europe, European competitiveness and the generative AI value chain. An early adopter of agentic AI, he brings agent workflows into research, data science and AI governance, and leads the AI transformation at the Centre for European Policy Studies.

WORK EXPERIENCE

HEAD OF APPLIED AI – AI WORLD – 01/11/2023 – Current – BRUSSELS, BELGIUM

Robert leads Data Analytics and Applied AI at AI World, the observatory tracking the global development of AI. He coordinates the State of Open Source AI reports with Hugging Face and has advised the European Commission and the United Nations on AI investment, open source AI and the AI Act.

DATA SCIENTIST – CENTRE FOR EUROPEAN POLICY STUDIES – 01/11/2024 – Current – BRUSSELS, BELGIUM

- Coordinated the State of Open Source AI 2024 and 2025 in collaboration with Hugging Face, some of this work was shared and presented by Yann LeCun and Jensen Huang, amongst others
- Setting up a work stream on AI and compute:
  - Publication with Hugging Face on transparency of hardware use for open models
  - Analyzing available European AI compute
- Core contributor to CEPS' AI World platform focused Frontier AI and European sovereignty on European's competitiveness through creating an ecosystem of excellence. Work among investigating author geography of top AI conferences and collaborating with Github on analyzing the share of agentic AI in software development
- Developed a tool for comparing the EU AI Act with US state laws on AI terminology for the Trade and Technology Dialogue

Wrote op-eds about DeepSeek R-1 and the AI Action Summit, and gave talks on Europe's industrial policy for AI, open source AI, the value chain of generative AI, European competitiveness in AI and the data landscape of startups in Europe

JUNIOR DATA SCIENTIST – CENTER FOR EUROPEAN POLICY STUDIES – 01/03/2024 – 31/10/2024 – BRUSSELS, BELGIUM

- Mapping the global AI investment landscape: trends, concentrations, and opportunities for the AI Office (09/2024)
  - Retrieved and analyzed global AI investment data with a focus on EU, US and China
  - Prepared the report and presentation
- Generative AI and foundation models in the EU: Uptake, opportunities, challenges and a way forward, funded by EESC (07/2024-02/2025)
  - Coordinating a multi-disciplinary team on analyzing the value chain of generative AI
  - Retrieving and classifying AI investments
  - Shaping the narrative to a diverse set of stakeholders including trade unions, industry and civil society
- Mapping AI in priority sectors and Ukraine competitiveness in AI funded by UNIDO (03/2024)
  - Led the retrieval of blockers, enablers and use cases of AI in 16 priority sectors
  - Analyzed data on patents, publications and investments

Given talks on AI innovation and regulation, digital rights and a moonshot for a European language model

VISITING FELLOW – CENTER FOR EUROPEAN POLICY STUDIES – 11/09/2023 – 29/02/2024 – BRUSSELS, BELGIUM

- Working on AI governance in the GRID (Governance, Regulation, Innovation and Digital Economy) Unit
- Investigating AI & robotics in agriculture for the Horizon Europe Flexigrobots project
- Working on AI terminology for Trade and Technology Dialogue
- Working out and presenting the idea for a European Large Language Model at CEPS Ideas Lab

MASTER THESIS INTERN – INSTITUTE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, MEDICAL UNIVERSITY OF VIENNA – 02/01/2023 – 31/07/2023 – VIENNA, AUSTRIA

- Working with Matthias Samwald on Chain-of-Thought reasoning in large language models
- Contributed to the Thoughtsource framework, an open-source platform that hosts datasets, language model access and evaluation tools
- Published several papers with the team in Nature Scientific Data and for a workshop at NeurIPS amongst others (See publications)

RESEARCH ASSISTANT – IMPACT CENTRE ERASMUS – 01/05/2019 – 01/05/2022 – ROTTERDAM, NETHERLANDS

- Performed tasks among data cleaning, data analysis and providing policy recommendations
- Provided statistics workshops to clients and co-workers
- We yearly assess the social impact reporting of the 100 biggest companies in the Netherlands

UNIVERSITY TEACHING ASSISTANT IN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE – KTH ROYAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY – 01/12/2021 – 28/02/2022 – STOCKHOLM, SWEDEN

- Graded student's essays, assignments and presentations
- Redesigned and oversaw the assignment on PDDL (planning)

OPERATIONS AND STRATEGY ANALYST – RAINFOREST CONNECTION – 01/05/2020 – 01/06/2021 – REMOTE, UNITED STATES

- Performed project planning
- Connected expenses to budgets
- Hired new interns
- Communicated with local partners

DATA SCIENCE VOLUNTEER – 510 AN INITIATIVE OF THE NETHERLANDS RED CROSS – 01/07/2019 – 31/01/2021 – THE HAGUE, NETHERLANDS

- Worked on disaster prediction models for the 'Impact Based Forecasting' project: https://www.510.global/impact-based-forecast/
- Built a web scraper to harvest impact data from Reliefweb: https://github.com/rodekruis/text_mining/tree/master/scrape_reliefweb/

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

01/08/2021 – 31/08/2023 Stockholm, Sweden

MASTER OF SCIENCE IN MACHINE LEARNING KTH Royal Institute of Technology

- Followed courses among (Advanced) Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Artificial Intelligence in Society, Philosophy of Science and Search Engines
- Teaching Assistant for the Artificial Intelligence course
- Worked on a search engine for endangered species (private repository) and classifying tweets about natural disasters: https://github.com/rodrigo-castellano/Disaster_tweets

Website https://www.kth.se/en/studies/master/machine-learning |

Thesis Self-Reflection on Chain-of-Thought Reasoning in Large Language Models

31/05/2023 – 07/09/2023 Brussels, Belgium

EU TECH POLICY FELLOWSHIP Training For Good

Followed a 10-week program in EU technology policy. I learned about legislative proposals around monitoring AI progress, general-purpose models, international cooperation, and audits and technical standards

Website https://www.trainingforgood.com/europe-tech-policy

01/08/2022 – 01/12/2022 Singapore, Singapore

POSTGRADUATE EXCHANGE Nanyang Technological University

- Followed courses in Policy Evaluation, Design of Experiments, Special topics in Probability & Statistics, Image Segmentation and Artificial Intelligence in Game Design

Website https://www.ntu.edu.sg

01/09/2017 – 01/08/2021 Rotterdam, Netherlands

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE ECONOMETRICS AND OPERATIONS RESEARCH Erasmus University Rotterdam

- Graduated with a 9.3 (out of 10) for a thesis on interpretability and fairness rules in machine learning models
- Relevant courses: Calculus, Linear algebra, Advanced Statistics, Simulation, Time Series Analysis, Econometrics, Programming; I used programming languages among Python, R, Java, MATLAB and STATA

Website www.eur.nl | **Thesis** Fair and Interpretable Decision Rules for Binary Classification

09/01/2020 – 31/01/2021 Delft, Netherlands

MINOR IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING Delft University of Technology

- Obtained 30 ECTS in Python programming, Software Engineering, Algorithms and Data Structures, Visual Data Processing, Data Analytics and Web scraping.
- Worked on a web scraping project for the Dutch Red Cross to retrieve impact data from Reliefweb: https://github.com/rodekruis/text_mining/tree/master/scrape_reliefweb/

Website https://www.tudelft.nl

01/09/2017 – 01/08/2021 Rotterdam, Netherlands

INTERNATIONAL BACHELOR ECONOMICS AND BUSINESS ECONOMICS Erasmus University Rotterdam

- Relevant courses: Accounting, Finance, Impact Evaluation (Economics) & Major in Strategy Economics

Website www.eur.nl

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): **DUTCH**

Other language(s):

	UNDERSTANDING		SPEAKING		WRITING
	Listening	Reading	Spoken production	Spoken interaction	
ENGLISH	C2	C2	C2	C2	C2
SPANISH	B2	B2	B1	B1	B2
FRENCH	B2	B2	B1	B1	B1

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user; B1 and B2: Independent user; C1 and C2: Proficient user

SKILLS

Python | machine learning | data science | R | Microsoft Excel | Microsoft Office | LaTex: used for documents preparation (e.g. reports and presentations). | Google Drive

PUBLICATIONS

2026

AI Hardware Choices are Highly Variable and Sparsely Disclosed

Francisco Ríos, Ian Reynolds, Robert Praas, Avijit Ghosh, & Irene Solaiman, 2026

2025

Building a European AI Ecosystem of Excellence, Foresight Report

Susana Aires, Harry Crichton-Miller, Nicoleta Kyosovska, Berta Mizsei, Davide Monaco, Laura Nurski, Federico Plantera, & Robert Praas, 2025

Authors: Susana Aires, Harry Crichton-Miller, Nicoleta Kyosovska, Berta Mizsei, Davide Monaco, Laura Nurski, Federico Plantera, Robert Praas

2024

Mapping the use of artificial intelligence in priority sectors and the competitiveness of Ukraine

Andrea Renda, Pierre-Alexandre Balland, Robert Praas, & Olesya Grabova, 2024

2023

ThoughtSource: A central hub for large language model reasoning data

Ott, S., Hebenstreit, K., Liévin, V. *et al.* ThoughtSource: A central hub for large language model reasoning data. *Sci Data* **10**, 528 (2023). https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-023-02433-3

2023

A collection of principles for guiding and evaluating large language models

Hebenstreit, K., Praas, R., & Samwald, M. (2023). A collection of principles for guiding and evaluating large language models. In Socially Responsible Language Modelling Research. Retrieved from https://openreview.net/forum?id=8iXdNXW34d

2024

A comparison of chain-of-thought reasoning strategies across datasets and models

Hebenstreit, K., Praas, R., Kiesewetter, L. P., & Samwald, M. (2024). A comparison of chain-of-thought reasoning strategies across datasets and models. *PeerJ Computer Science*, *10*, e1999.